

In his over 2.36 lakh km travel abroad, Fatmi's official visits are only 3 but he has spent 181 days on his 14 personal trips.

M.A.A. Fatmi, MoS for human resource development

Vayalar Ravi

Minister for overseas Indian affairs

Number of trips: 18

Km travelled: 2,83,036

OFFICIAL EXPENSES:

Rs 1.14 crore

Mani Shankar Aiyar

Minister for panchayati raj

Number of trips: 17

Km travelled: 2,09,239

OFFICIAL EXPENSES*:

Rs 40 lakh

*Some bills yet to be submitted

A. Raja

Minister for communications and IT

Number of trips: 12

Km travelled: 1,89,994

OFFICIAL EXPENSES:

Not provided

Vilas Muttemwar

MoS for new and renewable energy (I.C)*

Number of trips: 9

Km travelled: 1,56,025

OFFICIAL EXPENSES:

Rs 87.4 lakh

*Independent Charge

Saif-ud-Din Soz

Minister for water resources

Number of trips: 9

Km travelled: 65,704

OFFICIAL EXPENSES:

Rs 14.2 lakh

Prithviraj Chavan

MoS in PMO

Number of trips: 9

Km travelled: 92,400

OFFICIAL EXPENSES:

Not provided

Panabaka Lakshmi

MoS for health and family welfare

Number of trips: 8

Km travelled: 1,23,811

OFFICIAL EXPENSES:

Rs 28.6 lakh

E. Ahmad

MoS for external affairs

Days as minister: 1,287

NUMBER OF TRIPS: 79

Official: 76

Personal: 3

DAYS ABROAD: 232

Ahmad has spent 48 days in UAE during his 22 transit visits though Middle-East comes under his ministerial jurisdiction.

Official: 220

Personal: 12

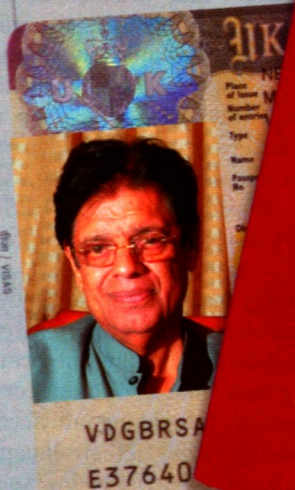
Km travelled: 6,13,277

Official: 5,99,015 km

Personal: 14,262 km

OFFICIAL EXPENSES:

Rs 1.37 crore



involved wives, mistresses or family shopping on Fifth Avenue at government (read public) expense. They do, however, show that some ministers are literally higher than others. In fact, some spent more time abroad on personal trips than on official visits.

Using the Right To Information (RTI) procedure, INDIA TODAY has obtained a de-

tailed list of ministerial travel abroad during the UPA Government's tenure and it makes for fascinating reading. It would have made better reading and comparative assessment if we had access to similar trips during the NDA regime too, but the almost 10 years that have passed since then meant that it was a far more laborious and time-consuming process. In any event, it took